

MB 531: Legal and Ethical Aspects of Business

Course Code	MB 531
Course Name	Legal and Ethical Aspects of Business
L-T-P-C	2-0-0-2
Prerequisites	Not Applicable
Intended for	MBA
Mutual Exclusion	Not applicable
Approval	52nd BoA (Nov 2023)
Revised	64th BoA (May 2026) - syllabus revised

Preamble

This course on Legal and Ethical Aspects of Business introduces students to the legal and ethical dimensions of modern business operations with a special emphasis on technology-enabled business environments. The course provides foundational understanding of legal principles relevant to managers, including contracts, business enterprises, company law, data protection, privacy, e-commerce, intellectual property rights, and cyber law.

The course also examines ethical issues in business and management by exploring individual, organizational, and societal dimensions of ethics. It introduces students to ethical decision-making, ethical leadership, organizational ethics, and the broader responsibilities of businesses in society. Special attention is given to the evolving legal and ethical challenges arising from digital technologies, online transactions, data ecosystems, privacy concerns, cybercrime, and emerging regulatory frameworks under the Digital India Act.

The course adopts a practical and managerial orientation by using illustrative case studies and application-oriented discussions to help students understand the legal and ethical implications of managerial decisions in contemporary business environments. Course objectives are as follows:

- Understand foundational legal concepts relevant to business and management.
- Develop an understanding of contract law, business enterprises, and regulatory systems governing business activities.
- Understand legal aspects of technology-enabled business environments including data protection, privacy, e-commerce, cyber law, and intellectual property rights.
- Develop awareness of ethical issues in business and managerial decision-making.
- Understand ethical leadership, organizational ethics, and societal responsibilities of businesses.

Course Modules

- **Foundations of Business Law:** Basic legal concepts for managers; introduction to law; legal systems; role of law in business. Fundamentals of contract law; legal aspects of business enterprises; basics of company law and corporate structures. Introduction to intellectual property rights; copyrights, trademarks, patents; protection of digital and technological innovations. (6 hours)
- **E-Commerce and Technology Law:** Legal compliance norms in e-commerce and m-commerce; cyber law; online transactions and digital governance. Cybercrime; freedom of speech on the internet; legal regulation of online conduct and digital platforms. (4 hours)
- **Data Protection and Privacy:** Data ecosystem under Digital India framework; law of privacy; legal implications of data management and digital interactions. (4 hours)
- **Ethics in Business and Management:** Introduction to ethics; ethical issues in business; individual, corporate, and societal ethical dimensions; ethical decision-making. (8 hours)
- **Ethical Organizations and Leadership:** Ethical organizations; ethical leadership; business responsibility toward society and environment. (6 hours)

Laboratory Modules

None

Text Books

1. Bill O'Rourke, Brad Agle, and Aaron Miller, *The Business Ethics Field Guide*, Merit Leadership, 2016.
2. Boatright, John R., *Ethics and the Conduct of Business*, Pearson Education, Indian Reprint, 2003.

References

1. A C Fernando, K P Muralidheeran, E K Satheesh, *Business Ethics: an Indian Perspective*, Pearson Education, 2019.
2. *The Value of Values: How Leaders Can Grow Their Businesses and Enhance Their Careers by Doing the Right Thing*, MIT Press, Daniel Aronson, 2024.
3. Andrew Crane, Dirk Matten, Sarah Glozer, Laura Spence, *Business Ethics*, Oxford University Press, 2020.
4. Rowan, John, and Zinaich, Jr., *Ethics for the Professions*, Wadsworth, 2003.
5. M.K. Kabi, *Legal Aspects of Business*, Taxmann Publications Pvt. Ltd., 2020.
6. Relevant readings and case materials on business law, cyber law, ethics, and technology governance will be provided during the course.